

School: Mulbarton Primary

Date: 04/05/23

Report: Onsite audit walk **DPE consultant:** Stuart Lee (SL) **School :** Natasha Hall

An onsite visit took place on the 4th May 2023. This was arranged to complete a physical afterschool audit of the school. The school is part of the Hethersett Cluster.

Audit walk feedback

Good practice was generally observed with minimal data on display. Folder and online systems used for sharing data securely. CPOMS is used for Safeguarding and StaffSafe for staff records. The server is in a locked location; each classroom has a lockable cupboard/cabinet and coat pegs displayed forename only. Where there was a teaching and learning justification for example, Reception classes, photo and forename was used. EHCPs and care plans are stored securely. The school is used by extended services with classrooms being locked at night and extended services having restricted access.

The following documents/best practice areas on the DPE website can be used to reference against and to obtain additional resources detailed in the report:

- [DPE compliance documents/consent guidance](#)
- [DPE quick reference guide](#)
- [Records management best practice](#)
- [Information and cyber security](#)

Audit walk observations and recommendations are detailed below:

Visitor sign in

Recommendations: Add the following statement to the visitor sign in system: Visitor information is collected for health and safety, record of official visits and safeguarding. If you would like to know more, the general/visitors privacy notice is available on the school website, or you can ask at reception for a paper copy (paper copy could go on the notice board). More guidance regarding visitor sign in systems is available [here](#).

Reception/visitor area

Staff photo displayed in an open area and is accessible to all visitors at reception.

Recommendation: Move to a contained area and/or seek consent for displaying staff photos. **Note:** consent can be verbal.

Reception office/offices

Positive observation with a clear desk policy being observed. Areas were clear of clutter. Shredders/bins used for securely destroying sensitive data. Adequate lockable storage and secure fob entry with restricted access.

Recommendation: The key cabinet would benefit with the key being added to a mini key coded safe for additional security.

Headteachers, deputies and finance offices

The headteacher office has key code entry with restricted access.

The deputy office is waiting to have a secure code entry to be added. Folders of medicines/joy are kept in the office.

The finance office had secure code entry, a clear desk policy was being practised with adequate secure storage for sensitive data.

Although there is restricted access, leadership team offices may have external visitors, including parents who could view information on display.

The headteacher and deputy offices had class list photos with full names of students.

Note: NH confirmed that a secure key code lock is being added to the deputies office.

Recommendations:

As above, add secure code entry to the deputies office.

Remove displayed photos from notice boards and add to a folder system.

Be conscious of sensitive files that may be accessible and store these securely. **Note:** cleaners etc do not have access to the headteacher's office unless the headteacher is present.

Photocopiers

Positive. Photocopiers have secure codes.

Classrooms

Each classroom has a cabinet/cupboard. No IT equipment was observed unlocked. Classrooms were generally kept clear and tidy. Each classroom has an assessment folder. Some cupboards would benefit from a declutter.

Some folders were observed with sensitive data; incorrect folder labelling; consent withdrawal/assessment/intervention on the back of the door(s) and photos with names on display.

Recommendations:

- Remind staff to add any folders that contain sensitive data (assessment/intervention etc) to available storage (end of day routines).
- Continue to complete a data cleanse of classrooms/cupboards checking for outdated and incorrectly labelled information.
- Remove sensitive data from the back of cupboard doors and add to folders; securing in cabinets/cupboards.

Laptops and iPads

No unlocked laptops/desktops were observed. All laptops have secure codes. In discussions with NH, staff use their own devices for accessing school information at home. This has been identified as a risk and NH is addressing this with purchasing school laptops in the near future.

Recommendations:

- Purchase organisation laptops for staff.
- Consider adopting DPE's [BYOD/work away from school](#) documentation and/or updating existing school documentation.
- Advise staff regarding best practice to ensure no organisational data is retained on personal devices i.e. delete downloads from personal devices and only access via the Cloud (avoiding downloads) etc.
- Consider additional training for staff i.e DPE's [Password nugget training](#).

Medical - first aid

Recommendations: Add as part of the end of day routines adding the first aid folder to the first aid cupboard, rather than being on open display.

General follow ups

- Action recommendations from the walk.
- School to check the archive cupboard and continue to complete a data cleanse, securely destroy outdated information.
- School to check if staff use any portable external hard drives/memory sticks.
- The school can develop start of year data management routines; encouraging staff to self regulate, checking physical/ online folders and deleting data no longer needed.
- Ensure staff have completed Stay Safe Online NCSC and GDPR training.

Note: Next steps remote meeting arranged for: **13th June - 10.30.**